



Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Conway, Arkansas	Accident Number:	CEN23LA073
Date & Time:	January 1, 2023, 14:00 Local	Registration:	N7003G
Aircraft:	Cessna 172K	Aircraft Damage:	Substantial
Defining Event:	Abnormal runway contact	Injuries:	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Instructional		

Analysis

The student pilot reported that, during landing, the airplane bounced and began too “fishtail” and he lost control of the airplane. When the pilot regained control of the airplane, the right main landing gear was off the runway and the airplane exited the runway into muddy ground. The airplane nose wheel became stuck, and the airplane nosed over and came to rest inverted. The airplane sustained substantial damage to wings and vertical stabilizer. The student pilot reported that there were no preaccident mechanical malfunctions or failures with the airplane that would have precluded normal operation.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The solo student pilot’s improper landing flare and subsequent improper recovery from a bounced landing.

Findings

Personnel issues	Aircraft control - Student/instructed pilot
Aircraft	Landing flare - Not attained/maintained
Personnel issues	Incorrect action performance - Student/instructed pilot

Factual Information

History of Flight

Landing	Abnormal runway contact (Defining event)
Landing-landing roll	Loss of control on ground

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	Age:	44,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	None	Seat Occupied:	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	Restraint Used:	3-point
Instrument Rating(s):	None	Second Pilot Present:	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	Toxicology Performed:	
Medical Certification:	Class 1 With waivers/limitations	Last FAA Medical Exam:	October 1, 2022
Occupational Pilot:	Yes	Last Flight Review or Equivalent:	
Flight Time:	(Estimated) 22 hours (Total, all aircraft), 22 hours (Total, this make and model)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	Registration:	N7003G
Model/Series:	172K	Aircraft Category:	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1968	Amateur Built:	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	Serial Number:	17258703
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	Seats:	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	December 7, 2022 100 hour	Certified Max Gross Wt.:	2200 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		Engines:	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	4224 Hrs as of last inspection	Engine Manufacturer:	Lycoming
ELT:	C91A installed, not activated	Engine Model/Series:	O-320E2D
Registered Owner:	On file	Rated Power:	150 Horsepower
Operator:	On file	Operating Certificate(s) Held:	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	Condition of Light:	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KCXW	Distance from Accident Site:	
Observation Time:		Direction from Accident Site:	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	Visibility	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	Visibility (RVR):	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	11 knots / None	Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:	None / None
Wind Direction:	180°	Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:	N/A / N/A
Altimeter Setting:	29.88 inches Hg	Temperature/Dew Point:	-6.7°C / -39.4°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Conway, AR	Type of Flight Plan Filed:	None
Destination:	Conway, AR	Type of Clearance:	None
Departure Time:		Type of Airspace:	Class E

Airport Information

Airport:	Conway Regional Airport KCXW	Runway Surface Type:	Concrete
Airport Elevation:	276 ft msl	Runway Surface Condition:	Dry
Runway Used:	22	IFR Approach:	None
Runway Length/Width:	5500 ft / 100 ft	VFR Approach/Landing:	Traffic pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	Aircraft Damage:	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:		Aircraft Fire:	None
Ground Injuries:		Aircraft Explosion:	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	Latitude, Longitude:	35.019889,-92.555111(est)

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Otterstrom, Kevin
Additional Participating Persons:	Nathan Bradshaw ; FAA / FSDO ; Little Rock , AR
Original Publish Date:	April 20, 2023
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.nts.gov/Docket?ProjectID=106524

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The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, “accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties ... and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person” (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB’s statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available [here](#).